

ERIC DAO

Enterprise CTO | Hands-on Builder + Strategy | Digital Transformation | Platform Modernization | Security | Data & AI | Blockchain/Web3

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SUMMARY

- Enterprise CTO and technology leader who builds hands-on and scales via strategy + operating model for mission-critical platforms.
- Drives measurable outcomes: growth (conversion/order volume), run-rate reduction, reliability, and security-by-design.
- Leads teams and budgets: 27-person org, ~USD\$150K/month tech spend; distributed leadership across Hong Kong + remote China teams.
- Operates at scale (daily): ~50M requests, ~2 TB served, ~1.5M visits; 100K+ IM messages processed/day.
- Background spans e-commerce marketplaces, fintech/Web3 infrastructure, IoT + AI, and Microsoft enterprise platforms (Redmond/Seattle).
- Demonstrated ability to thrive across Western and Greater China environments; multi-lingual leader bridging global stakeholders and execution teams.

CTO COMPETENCIES

- Digital transformation & modernization: platform re-architecture, modular layering, cloud-native patterns, migration planning.
- Financial & operational levers: cost optimization (FinOps mindset), vendor/tooling optimization, unit-economics thinking.
- Cloud & platform engineering: Kubernetes/Docker, CI/CD governance, release discipline, observability and reliability practices.
- Security-by-design: SAST/DAST, WAF, secrets management, PII controls/encryption, edge protection and abuse mitigation.
- Engineering productivity: automation strategy, quality gates, deployment velocity, predictable operations/debuggability.
- Data & AI enablement: LLM/RAG adoption, internal AI tooling, workflow automation, pragmatic application in production.
- Leadership: hiring/retention, org design, remote/distributed leadership (HK + China), executive stakeholder communication.

GLOBAL & MULTILINGUAL LEADERSHIP

- Languages: fluent English (written/spoken); fluent Chinese (Mandarin & Cantonese); working Vietnamese.
- Cross-region leadership: 12 years in the U.S. (Microsoft, Redmond/Seattle), 10 years in Beijing (China startups + founding experience), and 6 years in Hong Kong.
- Proven ability to operate effectively in both English-speaking and China environments—well-suited for companies with dual-market (China + global) business and stakeholders.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

Business & Financial Impact

- Improved order volume 25%+ by cutting purchase-flow friction 50% (1-click Buy Now redesign).
- Reduced run-rate costs ~30% via cloud adoption + workload-right architecture (incl. 8x storage cost reduction and serverless for transient workloads).
- Launched cloud video storage subscriptions (China + North America), increasing revenue 300%+; reduced cost of goods/services 25%; improved profit 30% via recurring revenue mix shift.
- Expanded Xiaomi-ecosystem home camera portfolio 3x within 1.5 years; doubled revenue and increased revenue per head 35%.
- Security program reduced external audit costs ~20% annually and strengthened customer trust/brand value.

Digital Transformation & Delivery Efficiency

- Re-architected platforms into layered MVP modules: reduced code complexity 50% (KLOC -50%) and improved quality 60% through testability and predictable failure modes.
- Increased deployment throughput 8x (from 1 deployment/day to up to 8/day) with GitLab CI/CD + Kubernetes tooling + image management discipline.
- Automation reduced time-to-release cycle 80% and lowered QA staff cost ~50% while increasing release confidence and consistency.
- Recognized for digital transformation impact: Standard Chartered Digital Transformation Corporate — Outstanding Award (2023, 2024).

Scale, Reliability & Security

- Operated high-scale marketplace platforms (daily): ~50M requests, ~2 TB served, ~1.5M visits; 100K+ IM messages processed/day.
- Sustained 99.995% availability with zero security incidents through SAST/DAST discipline, WAF protections, secrets management, and encryption at rest for PII.

Team & Global Leadership

- Recruited and retained top talent with <5% attrition over three years; led distributed Hong Kong + remote China engineering teams.
- Led 55+ cross-discipline engineering/product organizations; incubated and scaled engineering in China (5 → 42) at Microsoft.

Innovation: Patents + Web3 + AI

- Inventor: 10 patents filed + 1 pending (selected: Smart Contract protocol for payment-on-delivery, USPTO 62654352).
- Crypto/Web3: built Hyperledger Fabric networks and launched crypto exchanges; implemented custody controls (multisig workflows + custody partner).
- AI enablement: private first-pass code reviews (Ollama + Qwen 2.5), internal helpdesk AI (DeepSeek), and automation acceleration via MCP integrations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PRICE.COM.HK | IT Director (Engineering & Product)

Hong Kong | 2023 - Present

- Own enterprise platform strategy and execution across web/mobile/admin/API for an e-commerce marketplace; lead a 27-person engineering org across Hong Kong and a remote China team; manage ~USD\$150K/month tech spend.
- Recruited and retained top talent, maintaining <5% attrition over three years while raising bar on execution, ownership, and operational discipline.
- Improved order volume 25%+ by simplifying 1-click Buy Now flow, cutting purchase friction 50% and increasing conversion predictability across web and apps.
- Re-architected into layered MVP modules, reducing code complexity 50% (KLOC -50%); improved quality 60% by enabling layer-level + integrated automation and enforcing consistent UX/service behaviors.
- Operated reliably at scale (daily): ~50M requests (~2 TB served) and ~1.5M visits; processed 100K+ IM messages/day—sustaining 99.995% availability.
- Modernized delivery with GitLab CI/CD + Kubernetes tooling + image management; increased deployment throughput 8x (1/day to up to 8/day).
- Automation reduced time-to-release cycle 80% and lowered QA staff cost ~50% while improving release confidence (nightly + sanity automation, ~70% coverage).
- Reduced run-rate costs ~30% via cloud adoption, workload-right storage/DB choices, and serverless for transient workloads; moved static entities to object storage (8x storage cost reduction) and reduced support headcount by 2.
- Hardened security posture: SAST on check-ins/deployments; WAF for SQLi/XSS/bots; rate limiting + reCAPTCHA; encryption at rest for PII; regular OWASP ZAP scans; secrets management—maintaining zero security incidents and saving ~20% annual audit costs.
- Enabled pragmatic AI for engineering ops: local LLM (Ollama + Qwen 2.5) for private first-pass code reviews; DeepSeek for internal helpdesk; Playwright + MCP integrated with Claude for rapid automation prototyping; ChatGPT for experimental review features.

ALADDIN FINTECH COMPANY LIMITED | Technical Fellow & CTO

FinTech / Crypto / Web3 | 2018 - 2022

- Architected and implemented private/consortium blockchain networks (Hyperledger Fabric) for real-estate fractionalization and asset tokenization.
- Engineered smart-contract protocols to reduce disputes via enforceable on-chain rules; implemented DAO-style governance patterns for automated treasury/compliance logic.
- Directed launch of two crypto exchanges, including one that secured an operational license in Japan; provided architecture guidance to exchange leadership teams.
- Built exchange custody controls (multisig cold-to-hot workflows + custody partner) and secure hot/cold wallet systems aligned to stringent Japanese regulatory expectations.
- Company valuation reached ~USD\$30M after ~1.5 years of operation (at peak).

GURUMIND | CTO (Co-founder)

Beijing / Shanghai | 2017 - 2018

- Initiated and delivered a Retail 2.0 solution (Amazon Go-like) for offline in-store data collection to complement online site/app traffic and enable end-to-end customer journey analytics.
- Applied computer vision (object detection, tracking) and forecasting to generate aisle/area heatmaps and infer customer engagement and product interest.
- Collaborated with JD.com on experimental stores in Beijing; piloted system in multiple retail locations across Beijing and Shanghai.
- Filed 2 patents for retail store camera IoT device construct and data gathering.

SHANGHAI XIAOYI TECHNOLOGY (Xiaomi Ecosystem) | General Manager

Shanghai, China | 2015 - 2017

- Owned end-to-end product development and business operations for YI Home Camera with full P&L; responsibility; led 52-person cross-functional org.
- Shipped four home camera models in 1.5 years (2 entry/mid-tier and 2 high-end including AI hand-gesture control), expanding product offering 3x; doubled revenue and increased revenue per head 35%.
- Initiated and delivered cloud video storage subscription solution for China and North America, increasing revenue 300%+; reduced cost of goods/services 25% (hardware simplification and fewer returns) and improved profit 30% via shift to recurring revenue.
- Scaled YI Home Camera to #1 best-selling in China within 1.5 years and achieved Top 10 best-seller status on US Amazon; improved app ratings to 4.5+ stars across Google Play and iOS App Store.

MICROSOFT | Engineering Leadership (Exchange, Office, Office 365)

Redmond/Seattle, WA & China | 1993 - 2015

- Progressed from Software Design Engineer to Principal Group Engineering Manager; led up to 55+ engineers/PMs delivering enterprise messaging and administration platforms.
- Shipped multiple generations of Microsoft Exchange and foundational Windows Server messaging protocols (native NNTP/SMTP stack).
- Delivered enterprise high-availability for Exchange (Active/Active and Active/Passive on Microsoft Cluster Server), reducing planned downtime from hours to minutes for large customers.
- Delivered cloud and hybrid administration experiences, including Office 365 management capabilities spanning customer-managed vs Microsoft-managed operating models.
- Incubated Exchange engineering in China; scaled team 5 to 42 and expanded charter to shared cross-product ownership (Exchange, SharePoint, Office 365).
- Recognition & leadership development: Microsoft China Director/GM Award of the Year (2013); Microsoft Pillar Program graduate (Principal+ selective leadership program, 2011); Microsoft Bench Program graduate (2007).

PATENTS

10 filed | 1 pending (selected: Smart Contract protocol for payment-on-delivery, USPTO 62654352).

EDUCATION

University of Washington - M.S., Database & Network | Seattle, WA | 1996 - 1999

California Polytechnic State University - B.S., Computer Engineering (Summa Cum Laude) | San Luis Obispo, CA | 1990 - 1993

SELECTED TECHNOLOGIES

TypeScript/Python • Next.js • React • NestJS • Kubernetes/Docker • Git • CI/CD • Playwright • OWASP ZAP • WAF • SAST • AWS • Tencent Cloud (QCloud) • Cloudflare • Serverless • MySQL • PostgreSQL • NoSQL • n8n • Airflow • Splunk • LLM/RAG • Ollama • Qwen 2.5 • DeepSeek • MCP • Hyperledger Fabric • Smart Contracts (Web3) • Multisig Wallet